

FUEGO TEQUILA — UX/UI Audit for DTC Sales

fuegotequila.co.za | Shopify (Dawn theme) | 7 SKUs, R160–R469 | June 2026

Verdict: Strong brand imagery and a clean theme, but the store is missing the DTC fundamentals — stock signals, trust content, shipping clarity and email capture. Fixing the items below should be the difference between a brochure and a store that converts.

CRITICAL — CONVERSION BLOCKERS

- 1. No age verification gate** — An alcohol DTC store in SA needs an 18+ gate (Liquor Act compliance and payment-provider expectations). Add a lightweight age-gate app — one evening of work.
- 2. Zero shipping & policy information** — No delivery cost, timeframe or coverage anywhere; footer has no Shipping, Returns, T&Cs or Privacy pages (also an ECT Act requirement). Unanswered "how much / how long / can you deliver to me" is the #1 abandonment driver.
- 3. The 20% offer has no mechanism** — The header bar promises 20% off for subscribing, but there is no popup and only a bare email field buried in the footer. Add a popup with the offer + a welcome flow (e.g. Klaviyo) that actually delivers the code.

HIGH IMPACT — FIX THIS WEEK

- 4. Product pages are thin** — One-line descriptions, no ABV, bottle size, agave %, tasting notes or serve suggestions, and no reviews. Add a structured spec block, 2–3 lifestyle/serve photos, and a free reviews app (e.g. Judge.me).
- 5. Hero has no CTA** — "Play With Fire" looks great but there is no Shop Now button above the fold. Every hero needs one action.
- 6. "REPOSADE" typo** — Should be Reposado — it appears on the card, page title and URL. A spelling error on the hero product undermines the authenticity story.
- 7. No trust signals** — No reviews, press, awards or UGC; Instagram is the only social proof. Pull IG content onto the homepage and add payment/trust badges near add-to-cart.
- 8. SEO basics missing** — Homepage title and meta description are literally just "Fuego Tequila". Rewrite as e.g. "Fuego Tequila | Premium Hand-Bottled Tequila, South Africa — Free delivery over R850".

GROWTH — AOV & RETENTION

- 9. Bundles & free-shipping threshold** — Sell the trio (Blanco + Jalapeño + Reposado) as a set and set free delivery at ~R850 to pull single-bottle orders up to two.
- 10. Separate collections** — Bottles and R160–R200 cocktails sit in one undifferentiated grid. Split into "Tequila" and "Cocktails"; rename "N/A Margarita" to "Alcohol-Free Margarita".
- 11. Lifecycle email** — Once capture works: welcome (delivers the 20%), abandoned-cart, and a replenishment nudge ~45 days after purchase.
- 12. Polish the theme** — Inconsistent naming case (FUEGO BLANCO vs "Margarita"), duplicated headings in section blocks, and a contact form crammed mid-homepage — tidy the Dawn sections.

Priority order: 1) age gate → 2) shipping info + policy pages → 3) email popup + welcome flow → 4) PDP rebuild. Items 1–3 are days, not weeks, and gate everything else.